

What the System Remembers: The Second Attempt

系统记住了什么：第二次尝试

Theme: 科学、技术与互联网 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The second attempt began with a bit of **routine** maintenance and a kilo of new cable. **Its power** came from a smaller **motor**, a quieter **drive**, and an **electronic mixture** of sensors that could be arranged in any order. “If the **component** fails, the whole **activity** stops,” the engineer said. “That is the point.”

The **concert** in the park, the **bush** beside the path, and the **script** of the presentation were all part of the same **routine**. The **intensity** of the **mechanical** work was low; the **intensity** of the **mathematics** was not. A trigger in the software, a hook in the interface, and a chaos of small updates had to be replaced by **feedback**.

The **laser** scanned the surface, the **gravity sensor** dipped, and the **suspension** of the **scan** was logged twice. “**Consistency** is not **repetition**,” the analyst said. “A repeated test that changes nothing proves nothing.” An odor of burnt plastic, a graphic of the new **methodology**, and a projector that erased a digit: the lab was learning to trust **its** own instruments.

The **voltage** had to be upgraded before the consolidation of the two servers. An elimination of three old linkages, a cohesion of the remaining ones, and a relativity of standards between the two labs made the merge slower than anyone expected.

As an end to the attempt, they arranged one public session: a pull of the plug, a message on the screen, and a current of questions from the audience. “We can enable the exit,” Maya said. “We cannot enable the trust.” It was a level of honesty that the training had not prepared them for, and they waited at the end of the day for the result.

The mile of cable, the wait of a week, and the pick of the third option were, in the end, the same decision: to keep the system small enough to be explained by the person it remembers. It was an attempt at something small, and the training had prepared them for none of it. The current had turned; the force of the argument was on their side, and they could enable the end they wanted without a fight. A capture of one screen and a consolidate of two registers: the last step was to make the record smaller than the thing it described.

中文翻译

第二次尝试从一点例行维护和一公斤新电缆开始。它的动力来自一台更小的马达、更安静的驱动，以及一种可以任意排列的电子传感器混合物。“如果组件失效，整个活动就停下，”工程师说，“这正是要点。”

公园里的音乐会、小径旁的灌木，以及演示的脚本，都属于同一套例行安排。机械工作的强度不高；数学的强度则不然。软件里的一个触发器、界面上的一个钩子，以及一团混乱的小更新，都必须被反馈取代。

激光扫描表面，重力传感器下沉，扫描的悬停被记录了两次。“一致不是重复，”分析师说，“一个什么都没改变的重复测试，什么都证明不了。”一股烧焦塑料的气味、一张新方法论的图表，以及一台抹掉了一位数字的放映机：实验室正在学着信任自己的仪器。

在两台服务器合并之前，电压必须先升级。消除三条旧的连接、剩下几条的内聚，以及两个实验室之间标准的相对性，让这次合并比任何人预想的都慢。

作为这次尝试的结束，他们安排了一场公开会议：拔掉插头、屏幕上的一条消息，以及观众席涌来的一股问题。“我们能够开通退出，”曼雅说，“我们无法开通信任。”这是训练没能让他们准备好的一种诚实程度，而他们在一天结束时等待着结果。

那一英里电缆、那一周的等待，以及对第三个选项的选择，说到底都是同一个决定：让这个系统小到能被它所记住的那个人解释清楚。这是一次针对某种小东西的尝试，而训练没有让他们对其中任何一样做好准备。潮流已经转向；论证的力量在他们这一边，而他们可以不必争斗就促成他们想要的结局。截取一个屏幕、合并两份登记簿：最后一步，是让记录比它所描述的东西更小。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
its its POS: pron	pron. 它的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the branch of engineering that deals with the use of computers and telecommunications to retrieve and store...
power 'paʊə POS: n	n. 力, 体力, 力量, 势力, 动力, 权力, 强国, 乘方, 强度, 幂, 功率; vt. 使...有力量, 供以动力, 激励; [计]... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. possession of controlling influence; n. (physics) the rate of doing work; measured in watts (= joules/secon...
activity æk'tɪvɪti POS: n	n. 活动, 行动, 活跃, 活力; [计] 活动 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any specific behavior; n. (chemistry) the capacity of a substance to take part in a chemical reaction
drive draɪv POS: n	n. 驾车, 快车道, 推进力, 驱动, 动力, 击球, 驱动器; vt. 开车, 驱使, 推动, 驾驶; vi. 开车, 猛击, 飞跑; [计]... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of applying force to propel something; n. a mechanism by which force or power is transmitted in a m...
bit bɪt POS: n	n. 少量, 马嚼子, 辅币; vt. 给马上嚼子, 控制; bite的过去式和过去分词; [计] 比特, 二进制数位, 机内测试 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a small fragment of something broken off from the whole; n. piece of metal held in horse's mouth by reins a...
arrange ə'reɪndʒ POS: v	v. 安排, 排列, 达成协议; [计] 重排 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. put into a proper or systematic order; v. make arrangements for; v. adapt for performance in a different way...
component kəm'pəʊnənt POS: n	n. 元件, 组件, 成分; a. 组成的, 构成的; [计] 组件 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an abstract part of something; n. an artifact that is one of the individual parts of which a composite enti...
capture 'kæptʃə POS: n	n. 抓取, 战利品, 捕获之物; vt. 抓取, 获得, 迷住; [计] 截获命令 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of forcibly dispossessing an owner of property; n. a process whereby a star or planet holds an obje...
motor 'məʊtə POS: n	n. 马达, 发动机, 原动力, 汽车; a. 马达的, 发动机的, 汽车的, 发动的; vt. 推动, 以汽车载运; vi. 乘汽车, 驾车 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. machine that converts other forms of energy into mechanical energy and so imparts motion; n. a nonspecific...
electronic ˌɪlek'trɒnɪk POS: a	a. 电子的; [计] 电子工业协会接口 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to electronics; concerned with or using devices that operate on principles governing the be...
mixture 'mɪkstʃə POS: n	n. 混合, 混淆, 混合物; [化] 混合物 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (chemistry) a substance consisting of two or more substances mixed together (not in fixed proportions and...
routine ru:'ti:n POS: n	n. 常规, 日常工作, 惯例, 例行公事; a. 日常的, 常规的; [计] 例程 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an unvarying or habitual method or procedure; n. a set sequence of steps, part of larger computer program
concert 'kɒnsət POS: n	n. 音乐会, 和声, 一致; vt. 协力, 协调; vi. 协力; [计] 美国北卡罗来纳州Internet网 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a performance of music by players or singers not involving theatrical staging; v. contrive (a plan) by mutu...
bush bʊʃ POS: n	n. 矮树丛; [化] 管衬 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a large wilderness area; n. 43rd President of the United States; son of George Herbert Walker Bush (born in...
script skript POS: n	n. 手迹, 手稿, 正本, 手写体; vt. 改编为演出本; [计] 手写体, 小型程序 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a written version of a play or other dramatic composition; used in preparing for a performance; n. a partic...
intensity ɪn'tensəti POS: n	n. 强烈, 紧张, 强度; [计] 强度; 亮度 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the amount of energy transmitted (as by acoustic or electromagnetic radiation); n. high level or degree; th...
mechanical mɪ'kænikəl POS: a	a. 机械的, 机械性的, 力学的; [医] 机械的, 力学的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. using (or as if using) mechanisms or tools or devices; a. relating to or concerned with machinery or tools; ...
mathematics ,mæθə'mætiks POS: n	n. 数学; [机] 数学 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a science (or group of related sciences) dealing with the logic of quantity and shape and arrangement
trigger 'trɪɡə POS: n	n. 触发器, 扳机; vt. 触发, 发射, 引起; vi. 松开扳柄; [计] 切换开关 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a device that activates or releases or causes something to happen; n. an act that sets in motion some cours...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
chaos 'keɪs POS: n	n. 大混乱, 混沌; [化] 混沌; 浑沌 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a state of extreme confusion and disorder; n. the formless and disordered state of matter before the creati...
hook hʊk POS: n	n. 钩, 钩状, 镰刀, 陷阱; vt. 挂...于钩上, 钩住, 引上钩, 偷窃; vi. 弯成钩状, 钩紧; [计] 钩 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a catch for locking a door; n. a sharp curve or crook; a shape resembling a hook; n. a mechanical device tha...
update ʌp'deɪt POS: vt	vt. 更新, 使现代化; n. 更新; [计] 更新 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. news that updates your information; v. modernize or bring up to date; v. bring up to date; supply with recen...
feedback 'fi:dbæk POS: n	n. 反馈, 反应; [计] 反馈 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the process in which part of the output of a system is returned to its input in order to regulate its furt...
laser 'leɪzə POS: n	n. 激光; [计] 激光器 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an acronym for light amplification by stimulated emission of radiation; an optical device that produces an...
gravity 'grævɪti POS: n	n. 地心引力, 重力; [化] 重力 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (physics) the force of attraction between all masses in the universe; especially the attraction of the ear...
scan skæn POS: n	n. 审视, 浏览, 扫描, 细查; vt. 细看, 浏览, 扫描, 详细调查, 标出格律; vi. 押韵, 扫描; [计] 网络软件目录, 编... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of scanning; systematic examination of a prescribed region; n. an image produced by scanning; v. exa...
suspension sə'spenʃən POS: n	n. 悬挂, 暂停, 中止; [化] 悬浮; 悬浮体; 悬浮液 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a mixture in which fine particles are suspended in a fluid where they are supported by buoyancy; n. an inte...
dip dɪp POS: v	v. 浸, 降下, 把(手、勺等)伸入, 舀取; n. 浸, 涉猎; [计] 双列直插式组件, 分布式输入输出系统, 双排直插封装 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a depression in an otherwise level surface; n. (physics) the angle that a magnetic needle makes with the pl...
sensor 'sensə POS: n	n. 传感器; [计] 检测器 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n any device that receives a signal or stimulus (as heat or pressure or light or motion etc.) and responds to...
consistency kən'sɪstənsɪ POS: n	n. 坚硬性, 黏稠度, 一致性; [化] 稠度; 一致性 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the property of holding together and retaining its shape; n. a harmonious uniformity or agreement among thi...
repetition ,repɪ'tɪʃən POS: n	n. 重复, 背诵, 循环, 复制品, 副本; [机] 重复, 反复 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of doing or performing again; n. the repeated use of the same word or word pattern as a rhetorical...
odor 'əʊdə POS: n	n. 气味, 香味, 名声, 意味; [医] 气味 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n any property detected by the olfactory system; n the sensation that results when olfactory receptors in the...
graphic 'græfɪk POS: a	a. 生动的, 轮廓分明的, 绘画似的, 图解的; [计] 图形的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an image that is generated by a computer; s. written or drawn or engraved; s. describing nudity or sexual ac...
methodology ,meθə'dɒlədʒɪ POS: n	n. 方法学, 方法论; [化] 操作法; 工艺 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the branch of philosophy that analyzes the principles and procedures of inquiry in a particular discipline...
erase 'ɪreɪs POS: vt	vt. 抹去, 擦掉; [计] 清洗; 擦除; 抹除; DOS内部命令:从磁盘上删除一个或多个文件 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. remove from memory or existence; v. remove by or as if by rubbing or erasing; v. wipe out digitally or magne...
voltage 'vɔ:ltɪdʒ POS: n	n. 电压, 伏特数; [化] 电压 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the rate at which energy is drawn from a source that produces a flow of electricity in a circuit; expresse...
upgrade 'ʌpgreɪd POS: n	n. 上坡, 升级, 上升; adv. 往上; vt. 使升级, 提升, 改良品种; vi. 升级; [计] 升级 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. software that provides better performance than an earlier version did; n. a reservation that is improved; n. ...
consolidate kən'solɪdeɪt POS: vt	vt. 巩固, 使联合, 统一; vi. 巩固; [计] 合并计算 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. unite into one; v. make firm or secure; strengthen; v. bring together into a single whole or system; v. form...
elimination i.lɪm'i:neɪʃən POS: n	n. 除去, 消除, 消灭; [化] 消去; 脱去 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of removing or getting rid of something; n. the bodily process of discharging waste matter; n. analy...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
linkage 'lɪŋkɪdʒ POS: n	n. 联合, 连锁, 结合, 联动; [计] 连接 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an associative relation; n. (genetics) traits that tend to be inherited together as a consequence of an ass...
digit 'dɪdʒɪt POS: n	n. 数字, 位数, 指头; [计] 数位; 位 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. one of the elements that collectively form a system of numeration; n. a finger or toe in human beings or co...
cohesion kəʊ'hi:ʒən POS: n	n. 结合, 黏聚, 内聚; [计] 内聚性 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (botany) the process in some plants of parts growing together that are usually separate (such as petals); n...
projector prə'dʒektə POS: n	n. 计划人, 发起人, 规划人, 放映机, 映画器, 幻灯机, 幻灯, 探照灯, 发射器; [计] 投影仪 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an optical device for projecting a beam of light; n. an optical instrument that projects an enlarged image...
relativity ,relə'tɪvɪti POS: n	n. 有关系, 相关性, 相对性; [化] 相对性 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (physics) the theory that space and time are relative concepts rather than absolute concepts; n. the qualit...
kilo 'kɪləʊ POS: n	n. 千; [计] 千 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n one thousand grams; the basic unit of mass adopted under the Systeme International d'Unites